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Sep 28, 2025 • 1 tweets • cirnosad/status/1972189875958174102

You might be fooled by the media into thinking relationships form by isolating someone, taking them to a restaurant or some secluded place and then "getting to know each other" in a formal style interview.

No.

It happens within a social group and you get to know each other THROUGH that group. This is both true on the wire and in the physical realm. Our collapsed society and the boomer's war on the third places, as well as the rise in the need to be entertained through electronic means (starting with television) has completely killed our socialization.

From the 90s onwards, the soft patch was to force everyone on drugs and alcohol so that the boredom most people felt around others didn't act as a barrier. Smartphones killed that off. Clubs kept going until dating apps killed those off. Now there's nothing.

We all look back at university and feel a sense of nostalgia because the course work forced so many of us into close proximity. Meanwhile, the workplace does the opposite, pitting us against each other while HR policies create unnatural human boundaries.

Is there a way back to the way things used to be? I don't think so, at least not for our generations. But perhaps our role in this world is to serve as a warning for the future. A grim reality we will all have to contend with through little fault of our own.

We inherited the broken world the boomers and gen-X losers put together for us.

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